

battery consumption being the biggest of them. Although graphics were improving with these consoles, the prices were rising too. It was at this time that the designers of Nintendo took up the challenge of building a battery efficient, fairly priced gaming device which would be accessible to the average gamer and non gamer alike. And Voilà! The Gameboy was born. It was criticised heavily for having a small, monochromatic screen, at a time when other consoles supported a backlit chromatic display. However, Nintendo insisted that the main focus was not how the game looked, but how long you could play. Nintendo still needed that one title though, that would prove their theory, and their prayers were answered. Minoru Arakawa, the



The simplistic Gameboy. All the cool kids had it in the 90's

CEO of Nintendo at the time, saw a demonstration of a simple game and was immediately fascinated with how it worked. He got his team working to develop this game on the Gameboy. This title was called 'tetris' and it forever changed the gaming industry. Despite minimalistic graphics and having no real story, it became viral. It proved that you didn't need shiny sparkly graphics to make a good game work. All you needed apparently, is a lot of irregularly shaped blocks and a fun, challenging concept. That was more than enough for the Gameboy to make it big. Gameboy Colour was released in the following years with even better titles and as of 2001, the Gameboy and Gameboy Colour have sold more than 118 Million units worldwide.